

MAINUDDIN TALUKDAR

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29 August 2026

Hiring Team

Harkness AI

Christchurch Central City, Christchurch

Dear Hiring Team,

Re: AI Engineer Internship — Harkness AI R&D Project

I am applying for the AI Engineer internship on your funded R&D project. Building and benchmarking AI agents for real New Zealand SME workflows is exactly the work I have been teaching myself to do, and doing it alongside the founder on live client problems is the opportunity I have been looking for.

My stack maps directly to the role. I build full-stack products in TypeScript and Next.js with Supabase and Vercel, and I write Python for data pipelines, machine learning and automation. I use Claude and Claude Code, Cursor and Codex well beyond chat — for agentic coding, tool use and end-to-end workflows — and I have nine years of professional software engineering behind that, shipping production APIs, cloud services and mobile apps for financial and government platforms.

Most relevant, I have already been building this kind of system. TradiePulse, one of my side projects, is a conversational agent that takes a customer's household problem in plain language and connects them to the nearest available, qualified tradesperson — a plumber, electrician or mechanic — using a Next.js front end, a Python matching service and Supabase. Another, MathQuest, is a Next.js, Supabase and Vercel learning app for children that tracks how each child works through maths puzzles and calls a separate Python service to score them and suggest what to practise next. Both run as Dockerised services on my Hostinger VPS behind Caddy, deployed through a GitHub CI/CD pipeline, with the write-ups and live demos on my portfolio at mainuddintalukdar.cloud. Because so many AI benchmarks assume US data and workflows, I am keen to help close that gap for New Zealand businesses.

I am a Master of Artificial Intelligence student at the University of Canterbury (NZQA Level 9) here in Christchurch, so I am studying at an NZ tertiary institution and available full-time, on site, for the whole internship from 16 November through 22 January. I work best when I am trusted to own a problem, and I enjoy the client-facing side too — I like meeting people, understanding how a business actually runs, and turning that into something that works. Sitting in on real client meetings and presenting at a Young Kiwis in AI meetup both appeal to me a great deal.

I would welcome the chance to talk through how I would approach a small agent problem for one of your clients. Thank you for considering my application.

Yours sincerely,

Mainuddin Talukdar